

Pamela Dale- Rourke

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PROFILE

Dedicated and innovative Play Therapist with extensive experience in supporting children, particularly those with diverse communication needs. I specialize in utilizing creative methodologies to facilitate effective communication and emotional expression among young clients. My collaborative work with families, educators, and multidisciplinary teams has resulted in improved outcomes for children facing emotional, social, and behavioral challenges. Proficient in developing tailored resources that engage children and make therapeutic concepts more accessible. My commitment to inclusivity and understanding of diverse needs drives my practice, ensuring that every child can communicate their thoughts and feelings effectively. With personal insight into augmentative and alternative communication (AAC), I leverage this experience to enhance the support I provide to children and families.

EDUCATION

BSc | University of Central Lancashire

SKILLS

Strong digital skills for resource creation layout and design Mind Express 5
Widgit Online) Knowledge of AAC symbol systems (PCS SymbolStix Widgit
Bliss etc.) Understanding of inclusive communication SEN
and speech and language therapy Collaboration with therapists educators

HOBBIES



Travel



Reading



Photography



Music



Swimming



Fitness



Writing



Meditation



Art

CERTIFICATIONS

DDP (Diadic Developmental Psychotherapy) Health & Social Care (Preston College)
- Gained in-depth knowledge of therapeutic approaches that support emotional healing and development.

Play Therapy (Canterbury Christ University) - Developed skills in therapeutic play techniques, enabling effective engagement with children during sessions.

Filial Therapy in Family Therapy (Manchester) - Learned how to integrate family dynamics into therapy, promoting healthier relationships and communication among family members.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Service Lead for Schools | Child in Mind, Manchester | October 2016 - Present

- Developed and tailored communication and therapy resources that catered to the unique needs of children in schools, enhancing their ability to express themselves through visual supports and symbol-based activities.
- Provided high-quality 1:1 Play Therapy and Family Therapy sessions, specializing in psychotherapeutic assessments that inform customized therapeutic pathways for children exhibiting a range of behavioral and emotional difficulties.
- Collaborated closely with teachers and therapists to create accessible and engaging materials aimed at children with communication and learning needs, ensuring all resources were inclusive and user-friendly.
- Supervised postgraduate Play Therapy students, offering comprehensive training and ongoing guidance in resource utilization and inclusive communication strategies, fostering an environment of professional growth and development.
- Implemented innovative group therapy sessions that encouraged peer interaction and communication among children, promoting social skills and emotional intelligence.
- Conducted regular evaluations of therapy outcomes, utilizing feedback to adjust and refine therapeutic approaches to better meet the needs of children and families.
- Engaged in outreach programs within local schools, facilitating workshops for educators on child-centered communication strategies to improve classroom dynamics and student engagement.
- Participated in multidisciplinary team meetings to advocate for children's needs, ensuring a holistic approach to support that encompasses educational, emotional, and social development.

Play Therapist | Barnardos, St Helens | January 2015 - October 2016

- Created and implemented personalized visual and therapeutic resources to support children referred through CAMHS, successfully aiding in their emotional and social development.
- Contributed meaningfully to assessment meetings, providing insights and recommendations on appropriate communication supports for diverse referrals, ensuring that each child received tailored interventions.
- Managed a dynamic caseload of school-aged children, utilizing creative and resource-based approaches to address a wide spectrum of social, emotional, and communication challenges, leading to substantial improvements in their interaction skills.
- Facilitated group supervision sessions aimed at sharing best practices on child-centered communication strategies, promoting a collaborative learning environment among therapists.
- Developed and conducted training workshops for parents and caregivers, equipping them with tools to support their children's communication and emotional needs at home.
- Engaged in continuous professional development opportunities to enhance therapeutic skills and stay abreast of the latest evidence-based practices in child therapy.
- Established strong rapport with children and families, fostering trust and openness, which was critical in achieving positive therapeutic outcomes.
- Documented progress meticulously, utilizing data to inform future therapy sessions and adapt strategies as necessary.

Family Session Worker | OJs, Preston | May 2023 - January 2024

- Supported families with children on the autism spectrum by creating and adapting resources that facilitated engagement and effective communication, promoting a deeper understanding of each child's unique needs.
- Developed inclusive and interactive activities to ensure that children with communication differences could participate meaningfully in group settings, enhancing their social skills and confidence.
- Worked in close collaboration with families and colleagues to address individual needs, ensuring the resources were both practical and user-friendly, which empowered families in their support roles.
- Conducted regular follow-up sessions with families to assess progress and adapt strategies as required, ensuring ongoing support and development.
- Facilitated workshops for parents, focusing on communication techniques that they can use at home to strengthen their children's interpersonal skills.
- Engaged in community outreach to raise awareness about the needs of families with children on the autism spectrum, fostering a supportive network within the local community.
- Documented and reflected on session outcomes, using insights to inform future practice and enhance the effectiveness of interventions.
- Encouraged and guided families to celebrate small victories, reinforcing positive changes in behavior and communication.

Plan and Resource Creator | International school

- Planned and developed comprehensive literacy and learning resources tailored for primary-aged children, focusing on fostering a love for reading and writing through engaging materials.
- Created dynamic and visually appealing classroom materials that supported reading and writing development, contributing significantly to students' educational

outcomes.

- Collaborated with teachers to align resources with lesson objectives, ensuring that all materials were relevant and effective in meeting the diverse learning needs of students.
- Adapted activities to suit various learning needs and levels, ensuring inclusivity in educational practices and promoting equal opportunities for all learners.
- Evaluated the effectiveness of resources through student feedback and assessment outcomes, allowing for continual improvement of the materials created.
- Conducted workshops for educators on utilizing resources effectively in the classroom, fostering a collaborative teaching environment.
- Utilized creative approaches to engage students and encourage participation, resulting in improved communication and social skills in the classroom setting.
- Continuously researched new methodologies and resources to remain current in best practices for literacy development among diverse learners.